didn’t say anything about resigning; instead, he handed me a statement that he wanted me to issue declaring that he alone was in charge of foreign affairs. The statement was much too broad for me to accept, but after he left I drafted a statement of my own, short and simple, that made clear the obvious: that the secretary of state was my primary advisor on foreign affairs.

That seemed to satisfy him, and with the Haig issue behind us, I continued trying to enlist support on Capitol Hill for my economic recovery program; besides the usual schedule of meetings and conferences and telephone calls to congressmen, there was a banquet of television and radio correspondents at which Rich Little did a pretty fair imitation of me holding a press conference; a luncheon honoring members of baseball’s Hall of Fame, where I met players like Bob Lemon and Billy Herman whom I’d covered as a sports announcer; and on Saturday, March 28, the annual Gridiron Dinner, where reporters poked fun at presidents, congressmen, and other members of the Washington scene, and I got the chance to poke fun right back.

Sunday was a beautiful spring day and in the morning we went to St. John’s Episcopal Church, the house of worship not far from the White House that’s called “the President’s Church.” The choir from the U.S. Naval Academy at Annapolis sang beautifully and looked and sounded so right that I felt everyone in the church that morning must have felt very good about their country.

The main event on my schedule the following day was a speech to the AFL-CIO Building and Construction Trades Conference at the Hilton Hotel in downtown Washington. Although I spent most of that Sunday afternoon working on my speech, I thought a lot about those people I’d seen in church, the future of America, and the “MAD” policy.

The three initials stood for “mutual assured destruction,” three deceptively dull words describing our country’s only